

Kretz Lumber AI Leadership and Governance Quickstart

A step-by-step companion for the leadership training on AI tools, business impact, risk, and responsible adoption.

Purpose

This quickstart supports the two-hour Kretz Lumber leadership session. The training is designed to help leaders understand what AI tools can do, where they may create business value, what risks they introduce, and what governance structures should be in place before use spreads informally.

Core message

AI creates opportunity, but it also creates responsibility. Kretz does not need to adopt every new tool immediately. Kretz needs a clear, secure, and adaptable approach to using AI where it supports real work and protects the company.

Training flow at a glance

Section	Purpose	Leadership takeaway
Welcome and framing	Connect AI to leadership responsibility.	This is not just a technology topic.
What AI is and is not	Clarify capabilities and limits.	AI assists work; it does not replace judgment.
Real-world AI impacts	Show success and failure stories.	Governance prevents avoidable harm.
Current platforms	Understand tool categories.	Different tools fit different risks.
AI work products	Show useful outputs.	Drafts still need review.
Live demo	Convert rough information into usable outputs.	AI is strongest with context and constraints.
Prompt vs. process	Compare weak and structured use.	Process quality drives AI quality.
Kretz opportunity and risk	Identify practical use cases.	Every opportunity has governance needs.
Responsible adoption	Discuss policy, data, review, accountability.	Leadership must set the rules.
Next steps	Move toward responsible exploration.	Start small, measure, adapt.

1. Why governance is the center of this training

Kretz leadership is exploring AI from a governance-first perspective. The goal is not simply to impress people with tools. The goal is to build enough understanding for leaders to make careful decisions about platforms, employee use, data protection, customer-facing content, internal tools, and future investment.

Leadership questions to answer

Question	Why it matters
Which AI tools are approved?	Prevents uncontrolled use of public tools.
What information is protected?	Protects timber valuations, pricing, ESOP financials, customer information, employee information, and proprietary processes.
When is human review required?	Reduces risk of customer-facing mistakes, bad recommendations, hallucinations, and overreliance.
Who owns AI-assisted work?	Clarifies accountability when AI produces a draft, summary, or recommendation.
How do we report problems?	Creates a learning loop for hallucinations, inaccurate outputs, and unsafe workflows.

Facilitator prompt

Ask leaders: What AI use would make you most nervous if employees started doing it tomorrow without a policy?

2. Tool landscape for leadership

The point of this section is not to pick a final platform in the room. The point is to understand the categories of tools and the governance questions each category raises.

Tool category	Examples	Governance question
General AI assistants	ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini	What data can users enter, and when is review required?
Workplace copilots	Microsoft 365 Copilot, Google Workspace Gemini	Can the tool access internal files, email, or calendars safely?
Research tools	Perplexity, NotebookLM, AI search	How do we verify sources and avoid relying on poor evidence?
Creative tools	Canva AI, Adobe Firefly, image/video tools	Who approves public-facing materials and brand voice?
Automation tools	Zapier, Power Automate, Copilot Studio	What actions can AI trigger without human approval?
Industry tools	Scanning, grading, routing, optimization, machine vision	How do we validate outputs before operational decisions?

3. What AI does well and what it does poorly

AI tends to do well	AI tends to struggle with
Summarizing rough notes into a useful draft.	Knowing whether a statement is actually true.
Creating first drafts of emails, agendas, checklists, policies, and training materials.	Understanding Kretz-specific context without being taught.
Comparing options and organizing tradeoffs.	Making final legal, financial, safety, HR, or customer commitments.
Turning procedures into quizzes or training support.	Recognizing when source information is incomplete or outdated.
Helping brainstorm opportunities and risks.	Replacing expert judgment in forestry, sales, operations, or manufacturing.

Practice prompt

Give AI a rough customer or landowner note and ask it to produce: 1) a draft email, 2) an internal summary, 3) questions that still require human follow-up, and 4) statements that should not be promised without expert review.

4. AI News Break discussion guide

Use these cautionary examples as short discussion breaks. The goal is not fear. The goal is to make governance memorable.

News Break	Leadership lesson	Governance question
Customer-facing chatbot gives wrong information	If AI talks to customers, it represents the company.	Who approves customer-facing AI?
AI-generated fake citations or facts	Polished output can still be false.	Which outputs require verification?
Employees enter sensitive data into public tools	People will use AI even before policy exists.	What data is never allowed in public tools?
Automation pilot fails in real operations	A demo is not the same as deployment.	How will pilots be tested and measured?

5. Kretz prototype walkthroughs

Prototype 1: Kretz Haul Planner

Use this prototype to discuss route planning for pickups and drop-offs, logistics coordination, operational decision support, and the difference between a planning aid and a final dispatch decision.

Questions for leaders

What data would need to be accurate? Who would review the route? What could go wrong if the tool is wrong? What would make the output useful enough to maintain?

Prototype 2: Landowner Prospecting Tool

Use this prototype to discuss land opportunity identification, outreach emails, CRM possibilities, data quality, communication review, and business development workflows for land, sales, and forestry.

Questions for leaders

What sources should be trusted? Who approves outreach language? What should AI never promise? How should contacts, follow-ups, and notes be tracked?

Governance connection

Both prototypes are valuable because they make AI concrete. They also create the right governance questions: data quality, privacy, accuracy, ownership, human review, and ongoing maintenance.

6. Kretz DNA: voice, tone, values, vocabulary

Kretz DNA is the operating identity AI tools should reflect. It helps AI-assisted communication sound like Kretz rather than generic corporate text.

Element	Define it for Kretz
Voice	How should Kretz sound to landowners, customers, employees, and partners?
Tone	What balance of practical, professional, respectful, straightforward, and helpful feels right?
Values	How should employee ownership, stewardship, trust, safety, and quality show up in AI-assisted work?
Vocabulary	What industry terms, forestry language, product terms, and local references should tools use correctly?
Boundaries	What should AI never claim, promise, estimate, or decide without review?

7. Three practical governance procedures

A. The Sign-Off Rule

No AI-assisted content should be sent to customers, landowners, partners, employees, or external stakeholders without final human review when it involves pricing, commitments, recommendations, safety, legal, HR, financial, technical, or company reputation issues.

B. No-Fault Reporting

Employees should be able to report AI hallucinations, errors, tool problems, unsafe outputs, and confusing results without blame. The point is to improve prompts, tools, training, procedures, and policies.

C. Approved Tool Path

Kretz should identify which tools are allowed for general use, which tools are allowed only for approved teams, and which uses are prohibited until reviewed.

Use case	Possible rule
Generic meeting agenda or brainstorming	Allowed with low-risk information.
Customer or landowner communication	Allowed only as draft with human sign-off.
Confidential pricing, contracts, financials, ESOP data	Use only in approved secure environments, if allowed by policy.
Safety, HR, legal, financial, technical recommendations	Requires expert review before any use.
Unapproved public AI tools	Do not enter protected or proprietary information.

8. Opportunity and risk scoring worksheet

Use this scoring approach during the Kretz opportunity and risk discussion.

Potential AI use case	Value 1-5	Ease 1-5	Data sensitivity	Human review needed	Pilot?
Meeting summaries and action items			Low / Med / High	Low / Med / High	Yes / No
Landowner follow-up draft			Low / Med / High	Low / Med / High	Yes / No
Sales/customer response support			Low / Med / High	Low / Med / High	Yes / No
Safety toolbox talks			Low / Med / High	Low / Med / High	Yes / No
Routing / haul planning support			Low / Med / High	Low / Med / High	Yes / No

Land prospecting / outreach			Low / Med / High	Low / Med / High	Yes / No
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9. Next-step roadmap

Next step	What it means	Suggested owner
Refine AI governance and policy	Turn policy into specific daily rules and procedures.	Leadership + IT/security + Josh/NTC support
Select approved platform path	Compare ChatGPT Team, Copilot, and other options for usability, controls, cost, and longevity.	Leadership + IT/security
Define Kretz DNA	Capture company voice, tone, values, and vocabulary.	Leadership + office/marketing + forestry/sales
Identify tool builder/champions	Name internal people who can help test, maintain, and distribute approved workflows.	Leadership
Choose first pilots	Start with practical, repeated, manageable workflows.	Department leaders
Review and adapt quarterly	AI tools and costs will change. Policies and pilots should be reviewed regularly.	AI working group

Closing prompt

What do we want Kretz employees to be able to do with AI six months from now, and what must be true for leadership to feel comfortable with that?

10. GitHub Pages checklist

Use this checklist after uploading the updated files to the repository.

Check	Done?
index.html opens at willardwonder.github.io/kretz/	
Full training system link opens correctly	
Slide deck downloads correctly	
Step-by-step handout downloads correctly	
Governance quickstart downloads correctly	
Haul planner prototype opens correctly	
Landowner prospecting prototype opens correctly	
README.md accurately describes the training system	
No broken links on the landing page	